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Subject: IS547- Foundations of Data Curation

Progress Report

1. Project Summary

For my course project, I am applying the **CURATE(D) framework** to a Dryad dataset associated with the study “**A study of impulsivity and adverse childhood experiences in a population health setting.**” In this project, I am taking the role of a **research data curator** and evaluating whether the dataset is sufficiently documented, understandable, and reusable for future researchers. My use case focuses on assessing the dataset not just as a file deposit, but as a research object that should support transparency, interpretation, and responsible secondary use.

The dataset I selected is hosted in the **Dryad** repository and is associated with the following DOI: <https://doi.org/10.5061/dryad.66t1g1k8x>. The research context is related to **impulsivity, adverse childhood experiences (ACEs), and population health**, which makes this dataset especially important from a curation perspective because it relates to human-centered and potentially sensitive research. In addition to the repository deposit itself, I am also treating the **published article as central to the curation process**, since understanding and reusing the dataset depends heavily on how well the article and dataset work together.

My original curation goals were to assess the dataset’s **metadata quality, documentation, provenance, discoverability, and reuse readiness**. I also planned to evaluate whether the dataset and article together provide enough information for a secondary researcher to understand the study and responsibly reuse the shared data.

2. Status of Planned Deliverables

So far, I have completed the foundational parts of the project and made clear progress on the main deliverables from my original plan.

I have already:

- selected and justified the dataset,
- reviewed the Dryad repository record,
- created a formal dataset citation,
- identified the dataset’s DOI and metadata elements,
- reviewed the associated article,
- and started evaluating the relationship between the article and the shared data.

I have also begun assessing the dataset from a curation perspective by identifying what information is clearly available and what may still be missing for interpretation and reuse. This includes looking at **descriptive metadata, repository-level information, file organization, and discoverability**.

At this stage, the project has moved beyond only identifying the dataset and has entered the **preliminary evaluation and documentation review phase**. My planned deliverables related to **metadata assessment, documentation review, and article-dataset comparison** are now partially completed and continuing to develop.

3. Scope Changes / Adjustments

There has been a small but important refinement in the scope of my project based on professor's feedback. In my original plan, I intended to evaluate the dataset mainly through metadata, documentation, and reuse readiness. However, after feedback, I refined the project to place the **published article more centrally** in the curation workflow.

This means my project now more explicitly evaluates:

- how well the article supports understanding of the dataset,
- whether the dataset and article align clearly,
- what information may still be missing for reuse,
- and whether the shared materials appear consistent with **data sharing and repository expectations**.

This refinement has improved the project because it makes the curation assessment more realistic and more closely aligned with how researchers would actually encounter and use this dataset in practice.

4. Next Steps

My next steps are to continue the article-to-dataset comparison in more detail and document where the dataset is strong versus where it may need improvement. I also plan to assess the dataset more explicitly in terms of **reproducibility, transparency, provenance, and reuse support**.

In addition, I will review relevant **repository and data sharing expectations** to better understand whether the dataset aligns with common scholarly sharing practices. From there, I will develop a more structured set of **curation recommendations**, especially around metadata, documentation, and researcher usability.

Overall, I have made meaningful progress and now have a strong foundation for completing the full curation assessment in the final project.

GitHub Link- https://github.com/Bhagyesha-P/Foundations_of_Data_Curation

5. References

- [1] Read, R. W., Schlauch, K. A., Elhanan, G., Neveux, I., Koning, J. L., Cooper, B., & Grzyski, J. J. (2024). *Data from: A study of impulsivity and adverse childhood experiences in a population health setting* [Data set]. Dryad. <https://doi.org/10.5061/dryad.66t1g1k8x>
- [2] National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine. (2019). Reproducibility and replicability in science. The National Academies Press. <https://doi.org/10.17226/25303>

GenAI Declaration

I used Generative AI in a limited way to support organization, wording refinement, and editing of this report. The project content, dataset review, interpretation, and curation decisions were reviewed and revised by me based on my own understanding of the course material and project requirements.